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DJIA 46694.97 ▼ 63.31 0.14% NASDAQ 22941.67 ▲ 0.7% STOXX600 570.24 ▼ 0.04% 10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 11/32, yield 4.161% OIL \$61.69 ▲ \$0.81 GOLD \$3,948.50 ▲ \$67.70 EURO \$1.1715 YEN 150.35

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **OpenAI and** chip-designer Advanced Micro Devices announced a multibillion-dollar partnership to collaborate on artificial-intelligence data centers that will run on AMD processors. **A1**

◆ **Fifth Third Bancorp** said it would acquire Comerica for \$10.9 billion in an all-stock deal that would create one of the 20 largest banks in the U.S. **A1**

◆ **Paramount** agreed to acquire Bari Weiss's the Free Press for \$150 million and will install her as editor in chief of CBS News. **A1, A6**

◆ **Investor optimism** for additional rate cuts helped lift gold to a record \$3,948.50 a troy ounce and the S&P 500 and Nasdaq by 0.4% and 0.7%, respectively, also to records. The Dow fell 0.1%. **B9**

◆ **Verizon** appointed lead independent director Daniel Schulman as its new CEO as the telecom provider faces stiff competition for home internet and wireless customers. **B1**

◆ **Asahi** partially restarted beer production and shipments in Japan after its operations were disrupted by a ransomware attack last week. **B3**

◆ **Amgen** slashed the price of its cholesterol medication by more than half for U.S. patients through a new medication-access program. **B3**

◆ **Constellation Brands** posted lower second-quarter sales and cut its full-year earnings outlook again as its Hispanic customers continue to buy less beer. **B3**

◆ **Adnoc** offered concessions to the EU's competition regulator in a bid to end its probe of the company's \$13.7 billion offer for Covestro. **B2**

World-Wide

◆ **Illinois officials** sued to stop Trump from deploying National Guard forces to Chicago, as the administration's confrontation with Democratic-led states escalated. **A3**

◆ **The president** signaled a willingness to strike a deal on funding healthcare subsidies demanded by Democrats as the government shutdown continued. **A4**

◆ **The Supreme Court** declined to hear an appeal from Ghislaine Maxwell, the Jeffrey Epstein confidante who is serving a 20-year prison sentence for sex trafficking. **A6**

◆ **Mary E. Brunkow**, Fred Ramsdell and Shimon Sakaguchi were awarded the Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine for identifying how the immune system avoids attacking the body's own tissues. **A3**

◆ **Trump praised** a Kremlin proposal to extend the limits on long-range nuclear weapons under the New START treaty for another year. **A7**

◆ **Treasury Secretary** Scott Bessent appointed Frank Bisignano to the new position of chief executive of the Internal Revenue Service. **A2**

◆ **South Carolina** authorities investigating a fire at the home of a circuit court judge and a former Democratic state senator said there was no evidence the blaze was intentional. **A2**

◆ **The International Criminal Court** found a Sudanese militia leader guilty of committing war crimes and crimes against humanity two decades ago. **A9**

◆ **Venezuela** warned of an alleged plan by extremists to attack the shuttered U.S. Embassy complex in Caracas. **A10**

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Latest French Prime Minister Quits Tout Suite



STEPHANE MAHE/PRESS POOL

FIN: Sébastien Lecornu resigned Monday after a month in office, the fourth prime minister President Emmanuel Macron has lost in just over a year. The exit shows how a political system that was once a cornerstone of stability in Europe has fallen into disarray. **A7**

Regional Bank Mergers Heat Up With \$10.9 Billion Comerica Deal

Tie-up with Fifth Third would create one of the top 20 largest U.S. lenders

By GINA HEEB
AND CONNOR HART

Fifth Third Bancorp said it would acquire Comerica for \$10.9 billion, marking the latest effort by regional lenders to bulk up and compete with behemoths such as JPMorgan Chase and Bank of America.

The all-stock deal would create one of the top 20 largest banks in the U.S., with \$288 billion in total assets, accord-

ing to Federal Reserve data.

Bank executives and dealmakers will watch for signs of whether the acquisition will help usher in a long-anticipated wave of consolidation in the industry, where regional and community banks have struggled to keep up with technology, regulatory and other costs.

Some lenders see an opportunity to strike deals under the Trump administration, which has signaled a friendlier stance toward mergers and acquisitions.

This “appears to be a very supportive environment” for bank deals, Fifth Third Chief Financial Officer Bryan Pres-

ton said in an interview. He said regulators have signaled they believe consolidation is “healthy for the industry,” such as through faster approvals of bank tie-ups.

Gerard Cassidy, an analyst at RBC Capital Markets, said he thinks Fifth Third’s acquisition of Comerica could be a catalyst “to bring more deals to the table” if more banks come up for sale and are priced appropriately.

Comerica, based in Dallas, has more than 350 branches in Texas, California, Michigan, Arizona and Florida. Fifth Third, based in Cincinnati, operates 1,100 branches in the Midwest and the South. It

plans to build on Comerica’s commercial presence and expand deeper into retail.

Comerica has been under particular pressure to strike a deal.

Activist investor HoldCo Asset Management was poised to launch a board fight at the bank if it didn’t pursue a deal to sell itself, The Wall Street Journal reported.

The firm argued Comerica had mismanaged itself and would be better off as part of a bigger bank, with similar concerns shared by other top shareholders.

Shares of Comerica had trailed the industry in recent

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Israel’s Military Wins Leave Nation Isolated

By YAROSLAV TROFIMOV

Two years after deadly Hamas attacks triggered wars across the Middle East, negotiators are gathering in Egypt to try to end the bloodshed with a hostage deal and an Israeli pullback from the devastated Gaza Strip.

Israel is emerging from the carnage as the regional hegemon with a string of military victories. But the country’s fight against Palestinian militant group Hamas also has left it increasingly politically isolated and at risk of losing long-term Western support that has

been vital to its survival.

The deaths of more than 67,000 Palestinians in Gaza, local authorities said, have revived global calls for Palestinian statehood and put Israel at odds with an solidifying international consensus.

Once recovered from the initial shock of the Hamas breakthrough and murderous spree on Oct. 7, 2023, Israel’s military has delivered a succession of crippling blows to the entire constellation of its

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◆ **Netanyahu** enters talks with wide support **A8**

Young People Are Falling in Love With CDs and Digital Cameras

* * *

Driven by a feeling they’ve lost control, teens and 20-somethings resurrect old tech

By MAX KUTNER

Lucy Jackson uses a phone that can do little besides make a call and, with some effort, send a text. That complicates life for a college freshman in 2025.

But for Jackson, who uses paper maps and calls the local cab company when she needs a ride, the added challenges of low-tech life are a small price to pay.

“I have a lot more appreciation for things that I can’t access readily at my fingertips, like any kind of media,” said Jackson, 17. “It is a little bit

harder to make friends with people and keep in contact.”

Teens and twenty-somethings may have grown up consuming media on their phones, ordering food on apps and using rideshares, but some have had enough.

Driven by a desire to escape screens and reclaim a sense of control over their lives, they are resurrecting digital cameras, flip phones and CDs. It’s not unusual to see them roaming the aisles of a record store or doing sidewalk photo shoots with digital cameras, as if they had traveled

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INSIDE



GETTY IMAGES

PERSONAL JOURNAL

Rising annual fees push premium card users to choose sides. **A12**

U.S. NEWS

Supreme Court declines to hear Maxwell’s appeal of conviction. **A6**

Musk Bets Big On AI in Memphis

His artificial-intelligence company sprints to catch up in tech race

By ALEXANDER SAEEDY

MEMPHIS—For Elon Musk, ground zero of the artificial intelligence arms race is a 114-acre tract of grass and swamp on the state line of Tennessee and Mississippi.

This once-sleepy plot of land, filled with groves of water-rooted tupelo trees at its western edge, is now part of a growing empire Musk is accumulating in the Deep

South, just a few miles from Elvis Presley’s homestead at Graceland.

Labor crews hired by Musk’s xAI were excavating power equipment on the site—a defunct energy plant just over the state line in Mississippi—and preparing to build a new plant capable of generating over a gigawatt of electricity, enough to power around 800,000 homes. Engi-

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Head of ‘Anti-Woke’ Site Named CBS’s Top Editor

By JOE FLINT

Can Bari Weiss reinvent CBS News?

That is what Paramount Chief Executive David Ellison is betting on with a \$150 million deal to acquire the Free Press, the popular news and opinion site Weiss founded in 2021 as a check on what she saw as the media’s “woke” orthodoxy.

He is installing the outspoken journalist as editor in chief of CBS News and empowering her to set the storied news organization’s editorial vision.

“The combination of the Free Press and CBS News will create a news organization that ultimately becomes one of the most trusted destinations for news in this country,” Ellison said in an interview. “We want CBS to speak to that 70%

of the audience that would really define themselves at center-left to center-right.”

CBS News plans to launch a debate-style program that Weiss will oversee that is similar to debates the Free Press streams on topics ranging from immigration to the ethics of gene-editing embryos. Weiss will also continue as CEO and editor of the Free Press.

In an interview, Weiss said she and Ellison are aligned in their desire for “news that reflects reality” and journalism that “doesn’t seek to demonize, but seeks to understand.”

Terms of the acquisition, announced Monday, weren’t disclosed. It includes a mix of

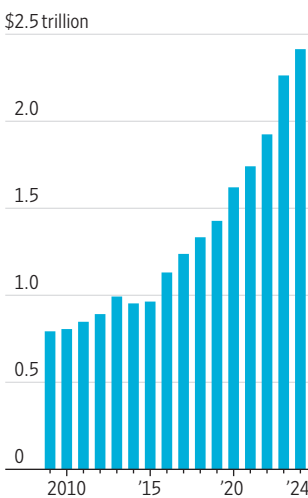
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◆ **Criticism of legacy media** drove Weiss to start site... **A6**

Reinsurers Go Off Shore

Life insurance and annuities reinsurers are increasingly storing the funds in less regulated offshore sites. **B1**

U.S. life and annuity reinsurance volumes



Source: S&P Global Markets Intelligence